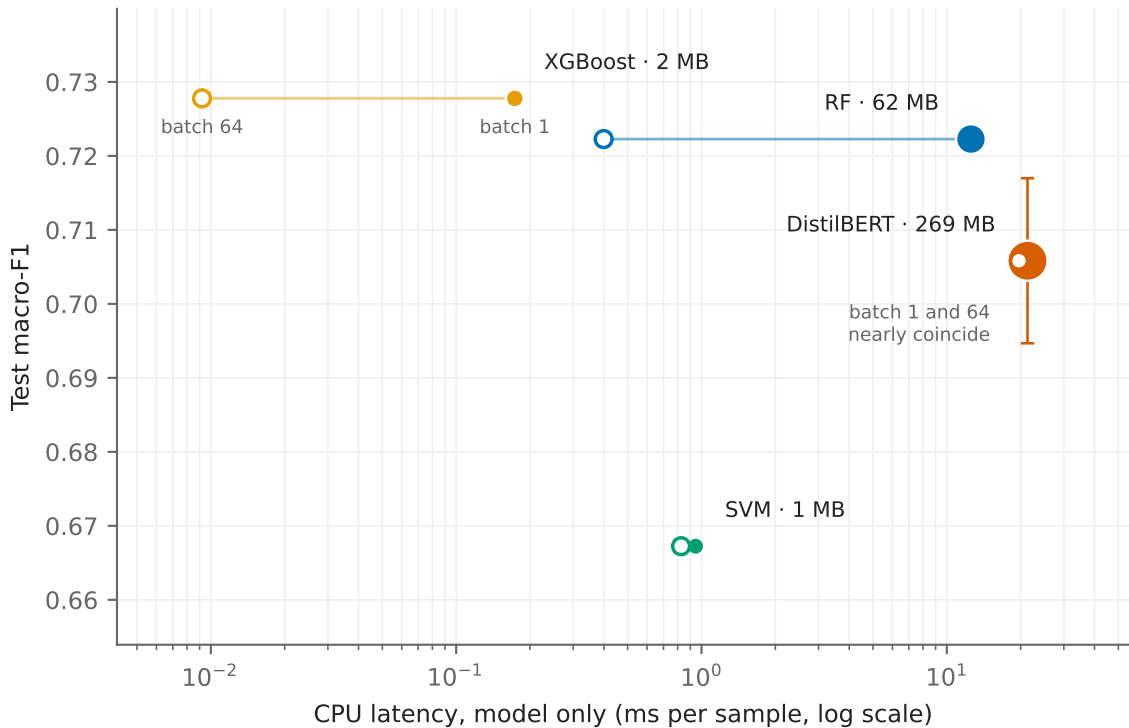


Accuracy against controlled CPU cost (RQ5)



Filled marker: batch 1 (area $\propto$ model size); open marker: batch 64. Same 512 test rows, same CPU, 4 threads.
DistilBERT: mean $\pm$ SD over seeds 42/123/2026. Classical models: the benchmarked seed-42 fits
(RF across seeds 0.7238 ± 0.0014 ; XGBoost seed-invariant).